

Present Perfect Continuous & Conditional Expressions

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Activity 1 – Multiple Choice

Present Perfect Continuous

1. She _____ on that research project since January.
✓ c) has been working
2. Why are your hands dirty?
✓ c) I have been repairing the car.
3. They look exhausted because they _____ all morning.
✓ b) have been running
4. How long _____ English?
✓ b) have you been studying
5. He _____ too hard lately and needs a vacation.
✓ b) has been working

Conditional Expressions

6. You can borrow my laptop _____ you return it tomorrow.
✓ c) as long as
7. We won't leave _____ everyone is ready.
✓ b) unless
8. Hurry up, _____ we'll miss the train.
✓ b) otherwise
9. I won't forgive him _____ he apologizes.
✓ b) unless
10. You may stay here _____ you respect the house rules.
✓ b) as long as

Activity 2 – Unscramble the Sentences

1. She has been studying all afternoon.
2. They have been working remotely for months.
3. You won't improve your English unless you practice.
4. We can start as long as everyone arrives on time.
5. Wear a jacket; otherwise you'll get sick.

Activity 3 – Match the Sentence Halves

Column A	Match	Column B
1. She has been exercising every day...	D.	D. ...and now she's in excellent shape.
2. You can participate...	C.	C. ...as long as you register today.
3. Call the hotel now...	A.	A. ...otherwise you'll lose your reservation.
4. He won't succeed...	B.	B. ...unless he changes his attitude.
5. We can continue the meeting...	E.	E. ...so long as everyone agrees.

Activity 4 – Fill in the Blank

1. They have been discussing the proposal for nearly three hours.
2. You may use my office as long as you leave everything organized.
3. We won't finish the project on time unless everyone contributes.
4. Sarah has been practicing the piano every evening this month.
5. Bring your passport; otherwise you won't be allowed to board.
6. He can stay with us so long as he respects our rules.
7. My neighbors have been making a lot of noise lately.
8. You won't pass the interview unless you prepare well.

Activity 5 – Error Correction

1. *I have been known her for years.*

✓ I have known her for years.

2. *He has been finish the report since yesterday.*

✓ He has been finishing the report since yesterday.

3. *Unless you will study, you won't pass.*

✓ Unless you study, you won't pass.

4. *You can stay here otherwise you respect the rules.*

✓ You can stay here as long as you respect the rules.

5. *They have been work together since 2022.*

✓ They have been working together since 2022.

Activity 6 – Choose the Best Explanation

A = Duration B = A recent activity with visible results

1. She's tired because she has been running.

✓ B

2. We have been living here for ten years.

✓ A

3. Your clothes are wet. Have you been walking in the rain?

✓ B

4. I've been reading this novel all week.

✓ A

5. They've been arguing again.

✓ B

Activity 7 – Complete the Dialogue

Emma: Why are you so tired?

James: I **have been working** overtime every day this week.

Emma: You should take a break.

James: I will, **as long as** I finish this project.

Emma: You need to rest, **otherwise** you'll get sick.

James: You're right. I probably should.

Activity 8 – True or False

1. "Unless" means the same as "if not."

✓ True

2. "Otherwise" introduces an alternative negative consequence.

✓ True

3. Present Perfect Continuous cannot describe actions that started in the past and continue now.

✓ False — it CAN describe actions that started in the past and continue now (e.g. "I have been studying since 9 am.").

4. "As long as" and "so long as" express conditions.

✓ True

5. We normally use "since" with a period of time and "for" with a starting point.

✓ False — it's the opposite: we use "for" with a period of time (for two hours) and "since" with a starting point (since 2020).

Activity 9 – Sentence Transformation

1. If you don't wear a helmet, you'll get injured.
✓ Unless you wear a helmet, you'll get injured.
2. You may stay here if you respect the rules.
✓ You may stay here as long as you respect the rules.
3. I've studied English for five years.
✓ I have been studying English for five years.
4. If you don't hurry, you'll miss the flight.
✓ Hurry up; otherwise you'll miss the flight.
5. She started writing the report three hours ago and she's still writing it.
✓ She has been writing the report for three hours.

Activity 10 – Speaking Challenge

Sample answers (each uses one Present Perfect Continuous sentence and one conditional expression):

1. I have been improving my English by watching movies with subtitles, as long as I dedicate at least thirty minutes a day to it.
2. I have been trying to change my habit of procrastinating, and I know I won't succeed unless I create a daily schedule.
3. University students should keep studying consistently as long as they want good grades.
4. Unless people manage their time well, they end up stressed and behind on their responsibilities.
5. I have been exercising and eating healthier meals lately, otherwise I would feel exhausted all the time.

Activity 11 – Paragraph Writing

Option A – selected

Describe a goal you have been working toward this year. Explain your progress and what conditions must be met to achieve it.

This year, I have been working toward improving my English, especially my speaking and writing skills. Since January, I have been studying grammar every day, and I have been practicing conversation with native speakers online twice a week. I have also been reading short stories in English to expand my vocabulary, and I have been listening to podcasts during my commute to train my ear. My progress has been steady, but I still have work to do. I will not reach an advanced level unless I keep practicing consistently every single day. I also know that I can only improve my pronunciation as long as I keep speaking with real people instead of just studying alone. By December, I hope to take a certification exam, and if I pass it, I will finally have proof of how much I have grown. For now, I will keep working hard, because consistency is the key to reaching any long-term goal.

(Word count: 158)